



The Ultimate Working Holiday Guide to Australia

Restructured Edition: Jobs from Entry-Level to High-Paying Positions

From Backpacker to \$200K Mining Professional — A 13-Year Journey



Job Tier Color-Coding System



GREEN: Entry-Level Jobs (\$20-35/hr)



YELLOW: Mid-Tier Jobs - Rigging & Scaffolding (\$45-65/hr)



LIGHT BROWN: Trade Jobs - Boilermaker, Fitter (\$55-80/hr)



BLUE: Mining & Senior Roles (\$65-110+/hr)



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Foreword

This guide is created to provide maximum value for those pursuing working holiday opportunities in Australia. Based on 13+ years of personal experience, it covers farming, construction, hospitality, and mining sectors — with recommendations tailored to your work history, intended stay duration, and budget for tickets and licenses.

"Wise people learn from other people's mistakes. I encourage you to learn from mine so you can avoid unnecessary suffering and bad financial decisions."

Part 1: Before You Start — Essential Foundations

Understanding Australian Working Holiday Visas

Visa Types

Visa Type	Subclass	Eligible Countries
Working Holiday visa	417	UK, Ireland, Canada, Germany, France, and others
Work and Holiday visa	462	USA, Argentina, Chile, Indonesia, Vietnam, and others

Basic Requirements

- Age: 18-30 years (some nationalities up to 35)
- Eligible passport with no dependent children
- Minimum funds: AUD \$5,000
- Must be outside Australia when applying for first visa
- Meet health and character requirements

Application Process

1. Create an ImmiAccount through the Australian Government immigration website
2. Start new visa application and select correct subclass
3. Fill in personal details, passport info, travel history, health and character questions
4. Upload documents (passport copy required; subclass 462 may need proof of education, bank statements, or government support letter)
5. Pay application fee — **AUD \$635**
6. Wait for decision — many approved within minutes or hours

Extending Your Stay:

- **Second visa:** Complete at least 3 months of specified work in approved regional areas
- **Third visa:** Complete 6 months of specified work while on your second visa
- **Total potential stay:** Up to 3 years on Working Holiday visas

Tax File Number (TFN)

When You Can Apply:

- You are in Australia
- You hold a valid visa (417, 462, student, temporary work, etc.)

Apply online through the Australian Government website once you arrive.

Why a Car is Your Best Investment

- Public transport in Australia is limited and unreliable
- Cars hold their value well due to higher usage tolerances
- A car helps you avoid expensive hostel traps (\$300+/week for shared dorms)
- One week in a hostel without working can cost \$2,000+ AUD

Used 4x4 Price Guide (2026)

Budget Range	Vehicle Options
Very Low Budget \$2,000-\$7,000	Older Great Wall 4x4 wagons, Honda CR-V, Mitsubishi ASX or RAV4
Mid Budget \$8,000-\$15,000	Mitsubishi Pajero, Toyota Kluger, Nissan Pathfinder, Navara/Triton utes
Higher Budget \$15,000+	Toyota Hilux, Land Cruiser Prado

Success Story: "I bought an 80-series Landcruiser at 377,000 km for \$11,000 AUD and sold it at 417,000 km for \$14,000 AUD."

Understanding Recruitment Agencies

How They Work:

- Used for construction, mining, and farming
- Agency charges client more than they pay you (margin = profit)
- Example: Agency charges \$70/hr, pays you \$40/hr = \$30/hr profit per worker

 **Key Points:** As a backpacker, you'll mostly work on casual basis with no paid sick days or holiday pay. **Avoid Gumtree jobs** — often cash-in-hand with no insurance.

Mastering the Job Search

"Think of sending your resume like planting a seed. You're in the recruitment agency's system — then you water it by calling when you don't hear back. Call at least once a week. Hearing back can take up to 3 months."

How to Call Recruitment Agencies

1. **Be calm** — don't rush or sound desperate
2. **Start with small talk** — "Hey, how are you going?" (wait for reply)
3. **Be specific** — state your name and the exact job you want
4. **Follow up** — having already sent your resume and following up sets you apart

Understanding FIFO (Fly-In Fly-Out)

What is FIFO?

FIFO (Fly-In Fly-Out) is a work arrangement common in the Australian mining and resources sector, particularly in remote areas of Western Australia. Workers fly from their home city (usually Perth) to a remote mine site, work a set roster (typically 2 weeks on, 1 week off), then fly home for their break.

How It Works:

-  **Flights:** Employer pays for your flights to and from the mine site
-  **Accommodation:** You stay in purpose-built mining camps on-site — FREE
-  **Meals:** All meals provided in the camp mess — FREE (breakfast, lunch, dinner + snacks)
-  **Transport:** Bus transfers from airport to camp and camp to work site — FREE
-  **Facilities:** Most camps have gym, recreation room, WiFi, laundry facilities



Modern FIFO mining camp accommodation
in the Pilbara, WA



Resort-style FIFO village with quality
amenities



The Savings Advantage of Living on Camp

Why FIFO = Maximum Savings:
While on camp, you have virtually ZERO living expenses. All your money goes straight to savings!

Living Expense	City Living (per month)	FIFO Camp (per month)
Rent/Accommodation	\$1,600 - \$2,500	\$0
Food/Groceries	\$600 - \$1,000	\$0
Utilities (electricity, water, internet)	\$200 - \$400	\$0
Transport/Fuel	\$300 - \$600	\$0
TOTAL MONTHLY SAVINGS	\$2,700 - \$4,500	\$0 expenses!

Real Example: A Mining Labourer earning \$48/hr on a 2:1 roster (84 hours/week while on site):

- Weekly earnings on site: ~\$4,000+ (with overtime)
- Monthly gross (2 weeks on): ~\$8,000 - \$10,000
- Since food & accommodation = FREE, most of this can be saved
- **Potential annual savings: \$80,000 - \$100,000+**

Common FIFO Rosters

Roster Type	Days On	Days Off	Best For

2:1	14 days	7 days	Most common, good balance
8:6	8 days	6 days	Better work-life balance
4:3	4 days	3 days	Drive-in drive-out (DIDO) roles
15:13	15 days	13 days	Senior/specialist roles



TIER 1: Entry-Level Jobs (\$20-\$28/hour)

1.1 Hospitality — Housekeeping & Cleaning

Job Description: Entry-level cleaning and housekeeping roles in hotels, hostels, and resorts.

Expected Pay:
Hourly: \$22-\$28 | Weekly (40 hrs): \$880-\$1,120 | Annual: \$45,000-\$58,000

Requirement	Cost	Notes
None mandatory	\$0	Basic entry-level position
RSA (optional)	\$60-\$150	Beneficial if role includes bar areas

 **Warning:** Avoid businesses offering unpaid trial days — this is illegal in Australia!

1.2 Hospitality — Restaurant & Café Work

Job Description: Food service roles including waiting tables, food preparation assistance, barista work, and kitchen hand duties.

Expected Pay:
Hourly: \$23-\$30 (casual rates) | Weekly (40 hrs): \$920-\$1,200 | Annual: \$48,000-\$62,000

Requirement	Cost	Validity
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RSA (Responsible Service of Alcohol)	\$60-\$150	State-specific, 3-5 years
Food Safety/Food Handler Certificate	\$80-\$150	Varies by state

 TIER 2: Seasonal Farm Work (\$25-\$40/hour)

2.1 Tractor Driving / Farm Hand RECOMMENDED

Job Description: Operating tractors and farm machinery for seeding, harvesting, and general farm operations. Modern tractors use GPS auto-steer systems — most driving is in straight lines across vast paddocks at 6 km/hour.

Expected Pay:
Hourly: \$28-\$40 | Weekly (50-60 hrs): \$1,400-\$2,400 | Seasonal (3-4 months): \$15,000-\$20,000+ saved

Real Example: "I saved around \$17,000 in four months driving a tractor."

Requirement	Cost	Notes
None required	\$0	Farmland is privately owned — no road licenses needed
First Aid Certificate (optional)	\$100-\$150	Some farms prefer this

Seeding Seasons Across Australia:

Crop Type	Season	Regions
Winter crops (wheat, barley, canola, oats)	Autumn: April-June	Southern Australia (WA, SA, VIC, NSW)
Summer crops (cotton, sorghum, maize, rice)	Spring-early summer: Sept-Dec	Northern NSW and QLD

Key Benefits:

-  Food and accommodation usually supplied (minimal expenses)
-  Counts towards 88 days for second visa
-  No experience necessary — training provided
-  No licenses needed on private farmland

2.2 Fruit Picking NOT RECOMMENDED** AVOID — Key Reasons:**

- Paid by piece rate, not hourly — often \$15-\$25/hour effective rate
- "Working hostels" overcharge for accommodation
- Exposure to pesticides causing rashes
- Inconsistent work (sent home when it rains)
- Often exploitative arrangements between hostels and farmers

●

TIER 3: Construction Work (\$35-\$50/hour)

3.1 Construction Labourer

Job Description: General labouring on construction sites including material handling, site cleanup, basic trades assistance, and operating small equipment.

Expected Pay:

Hourly: \$35-\$45 | Daily (10-hr shifts): \$350-\$450 | Weekly (50 hrs): \$1,750-\$2,250 | Annual: \$85,000-\$115,000

Real Example:

"My advice to French friends was to apply for a construction job outside the city. They both earned \$400 a day for a couple of months."

Required Tickets:

Requirement	Cost	Validity
White Card (Construction Induction)	\$80-\$150	Nationally recognized, no expiry
Standard Driver's License	—	Varies
Manual Handling Certificate	\$80-\$120	Typically 3 years

Optional But Valuable Tickets:

Ticket	Cost	Benefit
Working at Heights	\$200-\$350	Opens more job opportunities
EWP (Elevated Work Platform)	\$250-\$400	Operate scissor lifts, boom lifts

Forklift License (LF)	\$250-\$400	Essential for warehouse/site work
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3.2 Traffic Controller

Expected Pay:

Hourly: \$35-\$50 | Daily: \$350-\$500 | Weekly: \$1,750-\$2,500 | Annual: \$80,000-\$120,000

Requirement	Cost	Validity
Traffic Controller Ticket	\$250-\$400	3 years
White Card	\$80-\$150	No expiry
First Aid Certificate	\$100-\$150	3 years

● Rigging & Scaffolding Careers (\$45-\$65/hour)

These mid-tier roles offer excellent pay and are in high demand across mining, construction, and oil & gas sectors.



Industrial rigging work - crane and heavy lifting operations



Scaffolding construction work in Sydney, Australia



Crane and rigging services in mining operations



Construction rigger performing heavy lift operations

🔧 What is Rigging?

Riggers are responsible for safely moving heavy loads using cranes, hoists, and other lifting equipment. They set up and dismantle rigging equipment, select appropriate slings and lifting gear, and direct crane operators during lifts.

Rigging Career Levels:

Level	Description	Pay Range
Dogging	Entry-level: directing crane operators, slinging loads up to 20 tonnes	\$40-\$50/hr
Basic Rigging	Rigging equipment and loads, structural steel erection	\$45-\$55/hr
Intermediate Rigging	Multi-crane lifts, complex load calculations	\$55-\$65/hr
Advanced Rigging	Structural steel erection, moving/positioning machinery over 20 tonnes	\$60-\$75/hr



What is Scaffolding?

Scaffolders erect, alter, and dismantle scaffolding structures that provide temporary work platforms for construction and maintenance activities. It's physically demanding but highly rewarded.

Scaffolding Career Levels:

Level	Description	Pay Range
Basic Scaffolding	Prefabricated modular scaffolds, restricted heights	\$40-\$50/hr
Intermediate Scaffolding	Modular and tube scaffolds, most construction applications	\$50-\$60/hr
Advanced Scaffolding	Hung scaffolds, suspended scaffolds, complex structures	\$55-\$70/hr



Annual Earning Potential:

Intermediate Rigger (FIFO Mining): \$120,000 - \$150,000/year

Advanced Scaffolder (Shutdown Work): \$130,000 - \$160,000/year

Career Progression Path:

1

Start: Trade Assistant / Labourer

Get your White Card, work alongside qualified riggers/scaffolders

2

Get Licensed: Basic/Intermediate HRW Licence

Complete training course + assessment (1-2 weeks)

3

Gain Experience: 6-12 months

Build your resume with site experience, different companies

4

Advanced: Mining FIFO or Shutdown Work

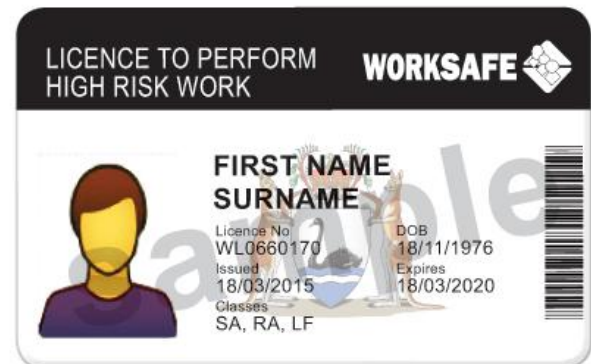
Advanced licence + mining tickets = \$60-\$75/hr

High Risk Work Licences (HRW)

High Risk Work Licences are nationally recognized credentials required by law to operate certain types of equipment or perform specific high-risk activities. They are issued by state WorkSafe authorities after completing approved training and assessment.



Various high risk work activities requiring licences



National High Risk Work Licence Card

Types of High Risk Work Licences

Licence Class	Description	Training Cost	Duration
DG - Dogging	Directing crane operators, slinging loads	\$800-\$1,200	3-5 days
RB - Basic Rigging	Setting up and rigging equipment	\$1,000-\$1,500	5 days
RI - Intermediate Rigging	Multi-crane lifts, structural steel	\$1,200-\$1,800	5-7 days
RA - Advanced Rigging	Heavy machinery, complex lifts	\$1,500-\$2,500	5-7 days

SB - Basic Scaffolding	Modular scaffolds, restricted heights	\$800-\$1,200	3-5 days
SI - Intermediate Scaffolding	Most scaffold types	\$1,000-\$1,500	5 days
SA - Advanced Scaffolding	Suspended and hung scaffolds	\$1,200-\$2,000	5-7 days
LF - Forklift	Operate forklift trucks	\$250-\$400	1-2 days
WP - Boom-type EWP	Boom lifts over 11 metres	\$300-\$500	1-2 days



Getting HRW Licences in Western Australia

Why WA is the Best Place to Get Licensed:

- Higher demand = more training providers = competitive prices
- Mining companies often offer to pay for tickets once employed
- Immediate job opportunities after getting licensed
- Construction Training Fund may reimburse your costs (see below)

Process to Get HRW Licence in WA:

1. **Choose an RTO (Registered Training Organisation)** — Look for TAFE WA, Nara Training, iCollege, etc.
2. **Complete the training course** — Combination of theory and practical assessment
3. **Pass the assessment** — Written test + practical demonstration
4. **Apply to WorkSafe WA** — Submit your Notice of Assessment (NOA)
5. **Receive your licence card** — Valid for 5 years Australia-wide

Popular Training Providers in WA:

Provider	Location	Speciality
TAFE WA (North Metropolitan)	Perth, Joondalup	Full range of HRW courses
Nara Training	Perth, Kalgoorlie	Mining-focused, rigging, scaffolding
iCollege	Perth	Construction tickets
ERGT Australia	Perth	Oil & gas, mining safety

 TIER 4: Mining Labourer & Trade Assistant

(\$48-\$55/hour)

 **Updated:** This tier has been renamed from "Mining Entry Level" to "Mining Labourer and Trade Assistant" to better reflect the actual roles and career pathway.

4.1 Mining Labourer / Trade Assistant

Job Description: General support work in underground or surface mines including ventilation maintenance, pipe installation (air, water, poly), equipment moving, ground support, and assisting trade qualified workers (boilermakers, fitters, electricians).

Expected Pay:
Hourly: **\$48-\$55/hour** (potential for more on night shift — up to \$60+/hr)
Daily (12-hr shifts): \$576-\$660/day | Roster: 2 weeks on, 1 week off
Annual: **\$110,000-\$140,000**

Required Tickets:

Requirement	Cost	Validity
Standard 11 (Generic Underground Induction)	\$300-\$500	5 years
Working at Heights	\$200-\$350	2-5 years
Confined Space	\$250-\$400	2-5 years
First Aid	\$100-\$150	3 years
Manual Handling	\$80-\$120	3 years

Driver's License (C Class minimum)



Why Western Australia is EASIER to Find Mining Work

134,009

Mining FTE Jobs in WA (2024-25)

47%

of Australia's Total Mining Workforce

11,065

New Workers Needed by 2029

\$200K+

Top Earner Potential

Why WA Dominates Mining Employment:

- 🏆 **Iron Ore Capital:** 65,496 FTE jobs in iron ore alone — massive Pilbara operations
- 🏆 **Gold Rush:** 35,672 FTE jobs in gold mining — Kalgoorlie, Goldfields region
- 📈 **Growth:** WA accounts for 40% of Australia's projected resource workforce growth
- 🛠️ **Skills Shortage:** Critical shortage of workers = easier to get hired
- ✈️ **FIFO Hub:** Perth is the gateway to all major mining regions

⚡ Shutdown Work in Western Australia

What is Shutdown Work? Mining operations periodically shut down for intensive maintenance, repairs, and equipment overhauls. These "shutdowns" require large numbers of workers for short, intense periods — perfect for backpackers!

Why Shutdown Work is GOLD for Working Holiday Makers:

- 💰 **Premium Pay:** Shutdown rates are often 10-20% higher than normal
- 📅 **Flexible:** Short-term contracts (2-6 weeks) — work intensively, then travel
- 🔄 **Year-Round:** Different mines have shutdowns throughout the year
- 🎓 **Experience:** Work alongside experienced tradespeople — learn quickly
- 🛠️ **Variety:** Work on different sites, different equipment, build your resume

Major WA Mining Regions for Shutdown Work:

Region	Main Commodities	Major Employers
Pilbara	Iron Ore	BHP, Rio Tinto, FMG, Roy Hill
Goldfields-Esperance	Gold, Nickel	Northern Star, Evolution, Gold Fields
Mid West	Iron Ore, Gold	Karara Mining, Westgold
South West	Alumina, Lithium	Alcoa, Talison Lithium

How to Find Shutdown Work:

- **Recruitment Agencies:** Programmed, Hays, Chandler Macleod, WorkPac, MAPS Group
- **Job Boards:** SEEK (search "shutdown"), Indeed, Jooble
- **Direct Applications:** FMS Group, Premium Mechanical Group, Centurion
- **Networking:** Once you're in, word of mouth is powerful

 Trade Careers: Boilermaker & Fitter (\$55-\$80/hour)

Trade-qualified workers are the backbone of the mining and construction industries. These roles require formal qualifications but offer exceptional earning potential.

Boilermaker

Job Description: Fabricating, assembling, and repairing metal structures, tanks, pressure vessels, and heavy equipment. Work includes cutting, welding, and fitting metal components.

Expected Pay:

Hourly: \$55-\$80/hour | Daily (12-hr shifts): \$660-\$960

Annual (FIFO Mining): \$140,000 - \$180,000+

Requirements:

Requirement	How to Get It
Certificate III in Engineering - Fabrication Trade	Apprenticeship (3-4 years) OR RPL
Welding Certifications (AS1796)	TAFE or RTO course
Mine site tickets	Standard 11, Working at Heights, Confined Space

Fitter / Mechanical Fitter

Job Description: Installing, maintaining, and repairing machinery and mechanical equipment. Includes reading technical drawings, using precision measuring tools, and fault diagnosis.

Expected Pay:

Hourly: \$55-\$75/hour | Daily (12-hr shifts): \$660-\$900

Annual (FIFO Mining): \$130,000 - \$170,000

Requirements:

Requirement	How to Get It
Certificate III in Engineering - Mechanical Trade	Apprenticeship (3-4 years) OR RPL
Hydraulics knowledge	On-the-job or additional courses
Mine site tickets	Standard 11, Working at Heights, Confined Space



TIER 5: Mining — Experienced Operators

(\$65-\$85/hour)

5.1 Machinery Operator (Dump Truck, Loader, Excavator)

Job Description: Operating heavy machinery including articulated dump trucks, loaders (CAT 996 etc.), excavators, and other large equipment on surface or underground mines.

Expected Pay:

Hourly: \$55-\$75/hour | Daily (12-hr shifts): \$660-\$900

Roster: 2:1 (2 weeks on, 1 week off)

Annual: \$130,000 - \$170,000

Required Tickets:

Requirement	Cost	Notes
HR License (Heavy Rigid)	\$1,500-\$3,000	Required for site driving
Relevant Machinery Ticket (VOCs)	\$400-\$1,000 each	Site-specific assessments
Standard 11 / Site Induction	\$300-\$500	5 years
Working at Heights	\$200-\$350	2-5 years

Common Machinery VOCs:

Equipment	Typical Cost
Articulated Dump Truck (ADT)	\$500-\$1,000

CAT 996 Loader

\$500-\$1,000

Excavator

\$500-\$1,000

Grader

\$500-\$1,000

Water Cart

\$300-\$500

● TIER 6: Mining — Senior & Specialist Roles

(\$85-\$110+/hour)

6.1 Mineral Process Operator

Job Description: Ensuring safe processing of in-load ore, communicating with control room to fault-find issues and minimise production loss. Inspecting work areas, using SAP for preventative maintenance scheduling.

Expected Pay:

Hourly: \$70-\$90/hour | Daily (12-hr shifts): \$840-\$1,080

Roster: Typically 15 days on, 13 days off

Annual: \$170,000 - \$210,000+

Real Example: "I currently work paying close to \$200K per year on a 15-day-on, 13-day-off roster."

Requirements:

- All Tier 4 & 5 tickets
- Process Plant Induction (site-specific)
- SAP/Maintenance Systems knowledge
- Dangerous Goods License (\$200-\$400)
- HR License (unrestricted)



RPL: Fast-Track to Trade Qualified

What is RPL (Recognition of Prior Learning)?

RPL is a formal assessment process that converts your existing work experience and skills into a nationally recognized qualification — **WITHOUT** years of apprenticeship!

Think of it as: Getting credit for what you already know how to do.

Why RPL is a Game-Changer

The Numbers Speak:

- 🕒 **Time Saved:** Get qualified in weeks, not 3-4 years
- 💰 **Pay Increase:** Trade qualified workers earn 30-50% more than trade assistants
- 📈 **Career Jump:** Go from \$48/hr (trade assistant) to \$65+/hr (tradesperson)
- 📋 **Licence Eligibility:** Many trades require qualifications for contractor licences

How RPL Works:

1. **Free Assessment:** Contact an RTO for initial eligibility check
2. **Evidence Collection:** Gather proof of your experience:
 - Resume and job descriptions
 - Photos/videos of your work
 - References from supervisors
 - Previous certificates and training records

3. **Assessment:** Qualified assessor reviews your evidence against national standards
4. **Gap Training:** If needed, complete short courses to fill any gaps
5. **Qualification Issued:** Receive your nationally recognized Certificate III

Trade Qualifications Available Through RPL:

Qualification	Typical Experience Required	RPL Cost
Cert III Engineering - Fabrication Trade (Boilermaker)	2-3 years	\$2,000-\$4,000
Cert III Engineering - Mechanical Trade (Fitter)	2-3 years	\$2,000-\$4,000
Cert III Carpentry	2-3 years	\$1,500-\$3,500
Cert III Wall and Floor Tiling	2-3 years	\$1,500-\$3,000
Cert III Civil Construction	2-3 years	\$1,500-\$3,500



Pro Tip for Working Holiday Makers:

If you have trade experience from your home country, RPL can convert it to Australian qualifications. This opens doors to much higher-paying roles immediately!

RPL Providers:

- TAFE Queensland — tafeqld.edu.au
- Trade Skills Australia — tradeskillsaustralia.com.au
- Qualify Me! — qualifyme.edu.au
- Noble Training Group — nobletraining.com.au
- Gimbal Group — gimbalgroup.com.au



TAFE Courses & Earning Potential

TAFE (Technical and Further Education) institutions offer practical, industry-focused training that can significantly boost your earning potential in Australia.

Welding Courses — High Demand, High Pay

Welding skills are in critical demand across mining, construction, and manufacturing. Even short courses can dramatically increase your employability and pay rate.

Course	Duration	Cost	Pay Boost
Introduction to Welding	3 days	~\$600	Entry to trade assistant roles
Welding Certification Preparatory (AS1796)	2-10 weeks	\$1,500-\$1,800	+\$5-10/hr for certified welders
TIG/GTAW Certification (Tickets 5, 7)	1-3 weeks	\$765	Premium TIG welding rates
Cert III Engineering Fabrication	12-48 months	\$3,000-\$27,800	Full trade qualification

AS1796 Welding Tickets Explained:

Ticket	Process	Industry Demand
Ticket 1	Manual Metal Arc (MMA) - Plate	High - general fabrication
Ticket 2	MMA - Pipe	Very High - pipeline work
Ticket 3E/3F	Gas Metal Arc (MIG/MAG)	High - production welding

Ticket 5	Gas Tungsten Arc (TIG) - Light gauge	Premium - precision work
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Ticket 7	TIG - Pipe	Premium - process piping
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Earning Potential with Welding Tickets:

- Trade Assistant (no tickets): \$35-45/hr
- Welder with AS1796 Tickets: \$50-65/hr
- Coded Welder (mining/oil & gas): \$65-85/hr
- **Annual difference: \$30,000 - \$50,000+ more per year!**

Construction Industry Training Fund

The Construction Industry Training Board (CITB) offers funding and subsidies for training in the construction sector. **You may be able to get your high risk tickets reimbursed!**

 **Note:** The CITB operates in South Australia. Other states have similar programs — check your state's training authority.

What Funding is Available?

For Workers (Short Course Training Support):

- Up to **\$3,000 in training subsidies annually**
- Covers CITB-endorsed short courses including:
 - High Risk Work Licences (rigging, scaffolding, dogging)
 - Working at Heights
 - Confined Space
 - EWP Licences
 - Forklift Licence
- Need a CITB number (free to apply)

For Employers (Apprenticeship Training Support):

- Up to **\$7,000** to offset apprentice training costs
- Additional incentives up to **\$20,000** for diversity and retention
- Completion incentive: \$1,000 per apprentice

How to Get Your Tickets Reimbursed:

1. **Get a CITB Number:** Apply free at citb.org.au
2. **Choose Approved Training:** Select a CITB-endorsed course

3. **Provide Your CITB Number:** Give it to the training provider at enrollment

4. **Subsidy Applied:** The subsidy is automatically applied to your course fee

Example Savings:

- Intermediate Rigging course: \$1,500 → After CITB subsidy: ~\$500-800
- Working at Heights + Confined Space: \$600 → After CITB subsidy: ~\$200-300
- **Save hundreds to thousands on essential tickets!**

State Training Authorities:

State	Authority	Website
South Australia	CITB	citb.org.au
Western Australia	Jobs and Skills WA	jobsandskills.wa.gov.au
Queensland	Construction Skills Queensland	csq.org.au
New South Wales	Training Services NSW	training.nsw.gov.au
Victoria	Skills Victoria	skills.vic.gov.au



Oil & Gas Offshore Pathways

The offshore oil and gas industry offers some of the highest-paying opportunities in Australia, but requires specific certifications and a significant investment in training.

Is Offshore Right for You?

Consider these factors before pursuing offshore work:

Factor	Consideration
Visa Duration	Need 6+ months remaining to make investment worthwhile
Budget for Tickets	Minimum \$3,000-5,000 for essential certifications
Physical Fitness	Demanding environment, strict medical requirements
Commitment	Extended rotations (2-4 weeks offshore at a time)

Essential Offshore Tickets & Costs

Certification	Cost	Duration	Validity
BOSIET with CA-EBS (Basic Offshore Safety Induction & Emergency Training)	\$2,000-\$2,500	2 days	4 years
HUET (Helicopter Underwater Escape Training)	Included in BOSIET	—	4 years
MSIC (Marine Security ID Card)	\$100-\$150	1-2 weeks processing	5 years

Offshore Medical	\$300-\$500	Same day	2 years
FOET with CA-EBS (Refresher after 4 years)	\$800-\$1,200	1 day	4 years

Additional Valuable Certifications:

Certification	Cost	For Roles In
Well Control (IWCF/IADC)	\$1,500-\$3,000	Drilling, well operations
IMDG (Dangerous Goods)	\$500-\$800	Deck crew, logistics
E-CHUTE (Escape Chute Training)	\$300-\$500	Newer rigs
Banksman/Slinger	\$500-\$800	Crane operations

Offshore Career Pathways

Entry Level Offshore Roles:

- **Roustabout:** General labouring, deck work — \$50-65/hr
- **Galley Hand/Steward:** Catering, cleaning — \$40-55/hr
- **Stores/Logistics:** Inventory, cargo handling — \$50-60/hr

Experienced Offshore Roles:

- **Derrickman/Floorhand:** Drilling operations — \$65-85/hr
- **Crane Operator:** Heavy lifting — \$70-90/hr
- **Production Technician:** Process operations — \$70-95/hr

Senior Offshore Roles:

- **Driller:** Drilling team leader — \$85-120/hr

- **OIM (Offshore Installation Manager):** Platform commander — \$150,000-\$300,000/year



Recommendations Based on Your Situation

🎯 If you have 6-12 months on your visa:

- Consider getting BOSIET if you have trade skills (welding, fitting, electrical)
- Start with onshore mining to build experience first
- Offshore companies prefer candidates with Australian work history

🎯 If you have 1-2 years remaining:

- Excellent time to invest in full offshore ticket package
- Get experience onshore first (6 months), then target offshore
- Build relationships with drilling contractors and service companies

🎯 If you're on a tight budget:

- Focus on mining first — similar pay, lower entry costs
- Use mining income to fund offshore tickets later
- Some employers sponsor BOSIET training for experienced workers

Offshore Training Providers:

- **ERGT Australia** (Perth) — ergt.edu.au — Premier oil & gas training
- **Survival Systems Australia** — Multiple locations

- **3t Global** — International provider with AU operations



Investment Summary — Tickets & Licenses

Starter Package (Budget: \$500-\$800)

Best for: Hospitality, Farming, Entry-level Construction

Ticket	Cost	Opens Jobs In
White Card	\$100	All construction sites
RSA	\$80	Hospitality with alcohol service
First Aid	\$150	All industries (preferred)
Manual Handling	\$100	All manual work
Total	~\$430	—

Construction Package (Budget: \$1,500-\$2,500)

Best for: Construction labouring, traffic control, warehouse work

Ticket	Cost
White Card	\$100
Working at Heights	\$300
EWP License	\$350
Forklift License	\$350
Traffic Controller	\$350

First Aid	\$150
Total	~\$1,600

Mining Starter Package (Budget: \$3,000-\$5,000)

Best for: Entry-level mining roles, trade assistant

Ticket	Cost
Standard 11 Induction	\$450
Working at Heights	\$300
Confined Space	\$350
First Aid	\$150
Manual Handling	\$100
HR License	\$2,000
Total	~\$3,350

Rigging/Scaffolding Package (Budget: \$4,000-\$6,000)

Best for: Mid-tier roles in mining and construction

Ticket	Cost
All Mining Starter tickets	\$3,350
Intermediate Rigging OR Scaffolding	\$1,200-\$1,500

Total

~\$4,500-\$5,000



Job Progression Roadmap

1

TIER 1: Hospitality/Cleaning (\$22-\$28/hr)

Investment: \$0-\$150 | Time: Immediate start

2

TIER 2: Seasonal Farm Work (\$28-\$40/hr)

Investment: \$0 | Time: Seasonal (get 88 days here!)

3

TIER 3: Construction (\$35-\$50/hr)

Investment: \$500-\$2,500 | Time: 1-3 months to find work

4

TIER 4: Mining Labourer / Trade Assistant (\$48-\$55/hr)

Investment: \$3,000-\$5,000 | Time: 1-3 months to find work

4b

Rigging & Scaffolding (\$45-\$65/hr)

Investment: \$4,000-\$6,000 | Time: 3-6 months experience

5

Trade Qualified (Boilermaker/Fitter) (\$55-\$80/hr)

Investment: RPL \$2,000-\$4,000 OR Apprenticeship | Time: Varies

6

TIER 5: Mining Operator (\$55-\$75/hr)

Investment: \$6,000-\$10,000 | Time: 6-12 months experience

7

● **TIER 6: Mining Senior/Specialist (\$70-\$90+/hr)**

Investment: Ongoing training | Time: 2-5+ years experience

POTENTIAL: \$170,000 - \$200,000+/year



Final Advice

Australian Work Culture

"Being German myself, I struggled with the idea of having to be perfect. Australia is different — there's a saying that Australia is 'easy going,' and it really is true. Everyone tweaks their resume a bit. Show that you are willing to learn and listen, and do not be arrogant."

The Key to Success

Your interpersonal skills play a bigger role than job experience for lower-tier jobs.

Show willingness to learn, be humble, and demonstrate reliability. This is also true for higher-paying mining jobs.

Avoiding Common Mistakes

1. **Don't get trapped in hostels** — expensive accommodation drains savings fast
2. **Don't travel in large groups** — job searching is more effective alone
3. **Don't limit yourself geographically** — apply Australia-wide
4. **Don't buy the cheapest car** — repairs can cost more than the vehicle
5. **Don't work cash-in-hand jobs** — no insurance, no protection
6. **Don't accept unpaid trials** — it's illegal in Australia

Essential Websites

Resource	URL	Purpose
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Seek	seek.com.au	Job listings
Indeed	au.indeed.com	Job listings
Immigration	immi.homeaffairs.gov.au	Visa applications
TFN Application	ato.gov.au	Tax File Number

This guide represents 13+ years of real experience. Follow the journey, learn from these mistakes, and create your own Australian success story.

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Organization: Jobs arranged from lower-paying to higher-paying positions with clear ticket/license requirements and color-coding system